

Glorification

doc-glorification

Soteriology · Glorification · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

breadth canon-wide
directness direct
variants stable

Statement under examination

At Christ's return, believers will be raised bodily, transformed, and glorified: the final consummation of salvation in resurrection bodies free from sin and decay.

In plain language

The Greek vocabulary across Paul and John supports the proposition with high consistency. Romans 8:30 ends a chain of four matching past-tense verbs with 'he glorified' (edoxasen), so the final glory is spoken of as already settled, even though the same chapter at verse 18 calls that glory still about to be revealed. First Corinthians 15:42 to 57 builds a sustained set of opposites. The body is sown in 'corruption' (phthora) and raised in 'incorruption' (aphtharsia). It is sown in dishonor and raised in 'glory' (doxa). It is sown in weakness and raised in power. It is sown a soulish body and raised a spiritual body. The same noun 'body' (soma) stays through every line, so this is the transformation of the body, not a swap for something non-bodily. Verse 53 says the corruptible must put on incorruption and the mortal must put on immortality, using a clothing image with the word 'it is necessary' (dei). Verse 51 says we shall all be changed at the last trumpet. Verse 54 quotes Isaiah 25:8 that death is swallowed up into victory. Philippians 3:21 says Christ will refashion the body of our lowliness so that it is conformed (symmorphon) to the body of his glory, and First John 3:2 says we shall be like him, using the adjective 'like' (homoios), because we shall see him as he is. Romans 8:18 to 23 widens the same hope to creation, which awaits the freedom of the glory of the children of God, and ties it to the redemption of the body. Two honest notes explain why readers can still differ on detail without touching the verdict. First, the words that specifically say the believer is glorified or conformed, the verb 'to glorify' (doxazo) applied to us and the rare term 'conformed' (symmorphos), are individually scarce, so the certainty comes from the whole pattern agreeing rather than from any single frequent word. Second, the timing and scheme of these events are not ranked by the vocabulary itself, which is where divergence lives. The lexical evidence is dense, repeated, and spread across several letters.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0076	Ἀδάμ	Adam	Adam	
G0110	ἀθανασία	athanasia	immortality	3
G0236	ἀλλάσσω	allasso	to change	6
G0444	ἄνθρωπος	anthrōpos	a human	
G0553	ἀπεκδέχομαι	apekdechomai	to expect	8
G0861	ἀφθαρσία	aphtharsia	incorruptibility	8
G1391	δόξα	doxa	glory	170
G1392	δοξάζω	doxazo	to glorify	62

G1453	ἐγείρω	egeiro	to arise	147
G1746	ἐνδύω	enduo	to put on	29
G2032	ἐπουράνιος	epouranios	heavenly	19
G2227	ζωοποιέω	zōopoieō	to make alive	
G2288	θάνατος	thanatos	death	121
G2937	κτίσις	ktisis	creation	19
G3345	μετασχηματίζω	metaschematizo	to transform	5
G3534	νίκος	nikos	victory	4
G3664	ὅμοιος	homoios	like	46
G3666	ὁμοιόω	homoioō	to liken	
G4152	πνευματικός	pneumatikos	spiritual	26
G4687	σπείρω	speiro	to sow	56
G4832	σύμμορφος	symmorphos	conformed	2
G4983	σῶμα	soma	body	144
G5356	φθορά	phthora	corruption	9
G5517	χοϊκός	choikos	made of dust	4
G5591	ψυχικός	psychikos	natural	6

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Paul's chain of past-tense verbs (aorist, a completed past action) in Romans 8:30 closes with 'he glorified' (edoxasen), placing glorification as the terminal link of the salvific sequence, stated in the same completed past tense of certainty as the prior verbs 'he predestined' (proorisen), 'he called' (ekalesen), and 'he justified' (edikaiosen). First Corinthians 15:42 to 57 builds a sustained antithetical lexical field: 'corruption' (phthora) versus 'incorruption' (aphtharsia), 'dishonor' (atimia) versus 'glory' (doxa), 'weakness' (astheneia) versus 'power' (dunamis), 'soulish' (psychikon) versus 'spiritual' (pneumatikon), and 'mortal' (thnetos) versus 'immortality' (athanasia), with the verbs 'it is raised' (egeiretai), 'we shall be changed' (allagesometha), and 'to put on' (endusasathai) naming the resurrection transformation while the noun 'body' (soma) is retained throughout. Philippians 3:21 caps it with 'he will refashion the body' (metaschematisei to soma) and 'conformed to the body of his glory' (symmorphon to somati tes doxes autou), and First John 3:2 with 'we shall be like him' (homoioi auto esometha) anchored to seeing him as he is. Romans 8:18 to 23 extends the hope to creation under 'corruption' (phthora) awaiting 'the freedom of the glory' (eleutherias tes doxes) and 'the redemption of the body' (apolytroisin tou somatos). The pattern is dense and spread across the whole Bible (pan-canonical) within Paul's and John's writings, and is not variant-sensitive at the verdict level. The verb 'to glorify' (doxazo) applied to the believer and the term 'conformed' (symmorphos) are individually rare, so the certainty rests on the convergence of the whole field rather than on the frequency of any single term.

Scripture

Rom.8.30 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1392 δοξάζω

Force. The chain of completed past-tense verbs (aorist, a completed past action) 'he predestined' (proorisen), 'he called' (ekalesen), 'he justified' (edikaïosen), and 'he glorified' (edoxasen) places 'he glorified' (edoxasen) as the terminal anticipatory (proleptic, spoken of in advance as already settled) act of the order of salvation, stated in the same completed past tense as the prior links so that the future glory is spoken of as already certain. Of the 62 canon uses of 'to glorify' (doxazo), the believer is the object of final glorification in only a handful, chiefly here and Romans 8:17, so the term is decisive here but not frequent.

Rom.8.29 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4832 σύμμορφος

Force. 'He predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son' (proorisen symmorphous tes eikonos tou huiou autou). The believer is predestined to be conformed to the image of the Son. This is one of only two canon uses of 'conformed' (symmorphos), and it sets up the same conformity that Philippians 3:21 will give to the resurrection body, making the verdict-bearing conformity language spread across all of Paul (pan-Pauline) rather than isolated.

1Cor.15.42 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G4687 σπείρω, G1453 ἐγείρω, G5356 φθορά, G0861 ἀφθαρσία

Force. The antithetical pairing 'it is sown in corruption, it is raised in incorruption' (speiretai en phthora, egeiretai en aphtharsia) binds resurrection to incorruption, with present passive verbs (ongoing action done to the subject) marking divine agency.

1Cor.15.43 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G1391 δόξα, G1453 ἐγείρω

Force. 'It is sown in dishonor, it is raised in glory' (speiretai en atimia, egeiretai en doxe) and 'it is sown in weakness, it is raised in power' (speiretai en astheneia, egeiretai en dunamei) extend the antithetical column, naming 'glory' (doxa) as the state into which the body is raised.

1Cor.15.44 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4983 σῶμα, G5591 ψυχικός, G4152 πνευματικός

Force. 'A soulish body' (soma psychikon) versus 'a spiritual body' (soma pneumatikon). The retained noun 'body' (soma) rules out disembodied survival, while the adjectives mark the qualitative transformation of the same body. 'Soulish' (psychikos) is rare, only 6 uses, but its contrast partner 'spiritual' (pneumatikos) and the kept noun 'body' (soma) fix the sense as animated-by-soul versus animated-by-Spirit.

1Cor.15.45 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0076 Ἀδάμ, G0444 ἄνθρωπος

Force. First-Adam, last-Adam pattern (typology, an Old Testament person prefiguring a New Testament reality): 'the first man Adam became a living soul, the last Adam a life-giving spirit' (ho protos anthropos Adam eis psychen zosan, ho eschatos Adam eis pneuma zoopoion). The last Adam is the source of the life-giving spirit that powers the resurrected body.

1Cor.15.47 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5517 χοϊκός, G0444 ἄνθρωπος

Force. 'The first man from the earth, earthy; the second man from heaven' (ho protos anthropos ek ges choikos, ho deuterios anthropos ex ouranou). The earthy versus heavenly polarity grounds the two-body classification (taxonomy, an ordered classification) in two representative humans. 'Earthy, made of dust' (choikos) occurs only 4 times, all in this paragraph, so its sense is set by this context alone.

1Cor.15.49 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5517 χοϊκός, G2032 ἐπουράνιος

Force. 'Just as we have borne the image of the earthy, we shall also bear the image of the heavenly' (kathos ephoresamen ten eikona tou choikou, phoresomen kai ten eikona tou epouraniou). The verb names the believer's assumption of the heavenly image, with 'image' (eikon) linking back to 'conformed to the image' (symmorphous tes eikonas) in Romans 8:29.

1Cor.15.50 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5356 φθορά, G0861 ἀφθαρσία

Force. 'Flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God, nor does corruption inherit incorruption' (sarx kai haima basileian theou kleronomesai ou dynatai, oude he phthora ten aphtharsian kleronomei). The inheritance of the kingdom requires the corruption-to-incorruption transition.

1Cor.15.51 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0236 ἀλλάσσω

Force. 'We shall all be changed' (pantes allagesometha). The future passive plural (a future action done to many subjects) locates the change as a future divine act on all who are Christ's. 'To change' (allasso) is used 6 times, twice here in verses 51 to 52 of this transformation.

1Cor.15.52 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1453 ἐγείρω, G0236 ἀλλάσσω

Force. 'The dead will be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed' (hoi nekroi egerthesontai aphthartoi, kai hemeis allagesometha). The dead are raised incorruptible and the living are changed at the end-time (eschatological, having to do with the last things) trumpet.

1Cor.15.53 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G1746 ἐνδύω, G0861 ἀφθαρσία, G0110 ἀθανασία

Force. 'For this corruptible must put on incorruption, and this mortal must put on immortality' (dei gar to phtharton touto endusasthai aphtharsian kai to thneton touto endusasthai athanasian). The clothing image names what must be put on, with 'it is necessary' (dei) marking divine necessity. 'Immortality' (athanasia) occurs only 3 times, but the paired 'incorruption' (aphtharsia) and the verb 'to put on' (endusasthai) fix the sense.

1Cor.15.54 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G2288 θάνατος, G3534 νίκος

Force. 'Death has been swallowed up into victory' (katepothe ho thanatos eis nikos) quotes Isaiah 25:8. Death is swallowed up into victory at the donning of incorruption.

1Cor.15.57 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3534 νίκος

Force. 'Who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ' (to didonti hemin to nikos dia tou kyriou hemon Iesou Christou). The victory over death is given through Christ, securing the resurrection outcome.

Phil.3.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3345 μετασχηματίζω, G4832 σύμμορφος, G4983 σῶμα, G1391 δόξα

Force. 'He will refashion the body of our lowliness conformed to the body of his glory' (metaschematisei to soma tes tapeinoseos hemon symmorphon to somati tes doxes autou). The verb 'to change in fashion' (metaschematizo) takes 'body' (soma) as its object, and 'conformed' (symmorphos), used with the 'to-form' grammatical case (dative), names the result. 'Conformed' (symmorphos) occurs only here and Romans 8:29, so its two uses both point to conformity to Christ, making the sense stable despite the rarity.

1John.3.2 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3664 ὅμοιος

Force. 'We shall be like him, because we shall see him as he is' (homoioi auto esometha, hoti opsometha auton kathos estin). The future state is likeness to the appearing Christ, with sight of him as he is as the formative cause. The word is 'like or resembling' (homoios), the adjective, with 46 canon uses, not the verbal 'to make like' (homoioo) of the parable formulas, so the claim is qualitative likeness to Christ.

Rom.8.18 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1391 δόξα

Force. 'The sufferings of this present time are not worthy compared with the coming glory to be revealed in us' (ouk axia ta pathemata tou nyn kairou pros ten mellousan doxan apokalyphthenai eis hemas). Present suffering is set against a coming 'glory' (doxa) yet to be revealed into us.

Rom.8.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2937 κρίσις, G5356 φθορά, G1391 δόξα

Force. 'The creation itself will be set free from the bondage of corruption into the freedom of the glory of the children of God' (he ktisis eleutherothesetai apo tes douleias tes phthoras eis ten eleutherian tes doxes ton teknon tou theou). 'Creation' (ktisis) itself is brought into the glory-freedom of the children of God.

Rom.8.23 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0553 ἀπεκδέχομαι, G4983 σῶμα

Force. 'Awaiting adoption, the redemption of our body' (apekdechomenoi huiiothesian, ten apolytrosin tou somatos hemon). The hoped-for adoption is identified with the redemption of the 'body' (soma), naming bodily resurrection as the content of glorification.

Col.3.4 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1391 δόξα

Force. 'When Christ is manifested, then you also will be manifested with him in glory' (hotan ho Christos phanerothe, tote kai hymeis syn auto phanerothesesthe en doxe). When Christ is manifested, the believers are manifested with him in 'glory' (doxa). The cross-reference network ties this directly to First John 3:2 and Philippians 3:21, repeating the appearing-then-glory sequence.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
1Cor.15.54	Isa.25.8	tsk	1
1Cor.15.54	Isa.25.8	openbible	1
1Cor.15.55	Hos.13.14	tsk	1
1Cor.15.55	Job.18.13	tsk	1
Phil.3.21	Isa.25.8	tsk	1
Phil.3.21	1John.3.2	openbible	1
Phil.3.21	Hos.13.14	openbible	1
Phil.3.21	Col.3.4	openbible	1
1John.3.2	Rom.8.29	openbible	1
1John.3.2	Col.3.4	openbible	1
1John.3.2	Ps.17.15	openbible	1

1John.3.2	Job.19.26	tsk	1
1Cor.15.49	Rom.8.29	openbible	1
1Cor.15.49	2Cor.3.18	openbible	1
1Cor.15.49	Matt.13.43	openbible	1
1Cor.15.49	Gen.5.3	tsk	1
1Cor.15.42	Gen.3.19	tsk	1
1Cor.15.43	Dan.12.1	tsk	1
Rom.8.19	Isa.65.17	tsk	1
Rom.8.23	Luke.20.36	openbible	1

Complicating texts

1Cor.15.50 · addressed

'Flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God' (sarx kai haima basileian theou kleronomesai ou dynatai) is sometimes read as denying bodily resurrection. The immediate context resolves this. Paul uses 'flesh and blood' (sarx kai haima) as a fixed idiom for mortal corruptible existence, paralleled by 'the corruption' (he phthora) in the same verse, then immediately predicts 'we shall be changed' (allagesometha) and 'to put on incorruption' (endusasthai aphtharsian), confirming continuity of 'body' (soma) with transformation of mode rather than abolition of the body.

1Cor.15.51 · addressed

'We shall not all sleep' (pantes ou koimethesometha) versus 'but we shall all be changed' (pantes de allagesometha) generates a textual variant cluster, but the verdict-bearing claim that all believers will be transformed at Christ's return holds across every plausible reading of the sleep-clause, since 'we shall be changed' (allagesometha) is undisputed in all witnesses.

Rom.8.30 · addressed

The completed past-tense (aorist) 'he glorified' (edoxasen) could be read as describing a past completed glorification rather than a future one, which would seem to argue against a still-future consummation. The construction resolves this. The verb stands in a chain of four completed past-tense verbs describing the whole order of salvation as one settled divine plan, and the same letter at verses 18 to 23 places the 'glory' (doxa) as 'about to be revealed' (mellousan), and ties it to the still-awaited 'redemption of the body' (apolytrosis tou somatos), so the completed past tense is anticipatory (proleptic) certainty, not past completion.

Concordance traversed

G1391, G1392, G0861, G5356, G0110, G4983, G4152, G5591, G1453, G0236, G1746, G4687, G5517, G2032, G0553, G2937, G2288, G3534, G4832, G3345, G3664, G3666, G2227

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

phoresomen-future-vs-phoresomen-subjunctive at 1Cor.15.49: impact none. Future indicative 'we shall bear' (phoresomen) versus completed past-tense subjunctive 'phoresomen' meaning the hortatory 'let us bear' is debated in the witnesses, but either reading still entails the believer's assumption of the heavenly image, so the verdict is not affected.

pantes-ou-koimethesometha-word-order at 1Cor.15.51: impact minor. Word-order variants around 'not all shall sleep' (ou pantes koimethesometha) versus 'all shall not sleep' (pantes ou koimethesometha) affect the scope of who sleeps but not the universal 'we shall all be changed' (allagesometha) clause that carries the doctrinal weight.

phtharton-thneton-clause-presence at 1Cor.15.54: impact none. Some witnesses omit one of the two parallel 'when' (hotan) clauses, 'the corruptible' (to phtharton) or 'the mortal' (to thneton), by a copying error where the scribe's eye skips between identical endings (homoeoteleuton), but the surviving clause and the Isaiah 25:8 citation 'death has been swallowed up into victory' (katepothe ho thanatos eis nikos) preserve the death-defeat outcome in every reading.

None of the anchors fall in the published window of the genealogical text-critical method (CBGM, the Coherence-Based Genealogical Method), which covers only Third John 1:1 to 1:15. The New Testament anchors are read against the MorphGNT and SBLGNT critical text and the STEP Bible apparatus (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) without CBGM-grade arbitration, so variant signal is treated as shadow.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. redemptive-historical

Frameworks in play. pauline_apocalyptic, redemptive_historical_arc, already_not_yet

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

bodily_resurrection_realism: affirms · The noun 'body' (soma) is retained through First Corinthians 15:42 to 44 with only the modifier changing, 'soulish' (psychikon) to 'spiritual' (pneumatikon), and Philippians 3:21 makes the same 'body of our lowliness' (soma tes tapeinoseos) the object of 'to change in fashion' (metaschematizo) and the subject of 'conformed to the body of his glory' (symmorphon to somati tes doxes), so the future state is a transformed body, not a new substance.

spiritualized_immortality_only: fails · A reading that reduces the future to disembodied immortality would have to discard the repeated noun 'body' (soma), the verbs 'it is raised' (egeiretai) and 'we shall be changed' (allagesometha), and 'the redemption of the body' (apolytrosin tou somatos) in Romans 8:23. Stated in its strongest form, it leans on 'spiritual body' (soma pneumatikon) meaning non-physical, but 'spiritual' (pneumatikos) elsewhere in the same letter modifies physical realities such as food and drink and rock in First Corinthians 10, so the adjective marks the animating power, not the absence of body.

realized_eschatology_only: fails · In its strongest form this lens points to the completed past-tense (aorist) 'he glorified' (edoxasen) in Romans 8:30 as glory already accomplished. But the same passage marks the 'glory' (doxa) as 'about to be revealed' (mellousan) in verse 18, and the cluster of future-tense verbs 'we shall bear' (phoresomen), 'we shall be changed' (allagesometha), 'they will be raised' (egerthesontai), 'it will be set free' (eleutherothesetai), 'we shall see' (opsometha), 'we shall be' (esometha), and 'awaiting' (apekdechomenoi) place the consummation in the future, so the completed past tense functions as anticipatory (proleptic) certainty within a not-yet horizon.

timing_and_scope_open: underdetermined · The vocabulary fixes that believers will be glorified, bodily, conformed to Christ, but it does not by itself rank the timing details, such as the relation of the resurrection to a thousand-year (millennial) scheme or the exact ordering of the living and the dead beyond 'in an instant' (en atomo) at the last trumpet. This is where readers can legitimately diverge, but the divergence is over schedule and not over the verdict that final glorification occurs.

The lexical case turns on the convergence of three things: the retained noun 'body' (soma) with future-passive resurrection verbs, the antithetical outcome vocabulary 'glory' (doxa), 'incorruption' (aphtharsia), 'immortality' (athanasia) against 'corruption' (phthora), 'dishonor' (atimia), 'mortal' (thnetos), and the conformity terms 'conformed' (symmorphos) and 'like' (homoios) tied to Christ, all cross-referenced to the Old Testament death-defeat texts Isaiah 25:8 and Hosea 13:14 through direct citation in First Corinthians 15:54 to 55.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem describes a future end-time (eschatological) state and its content: raised bodily, transformed, glorified, free from sin and decay, without smuggling a contested mechanism or a tradition-specific taxonomy (ordered classification). The terms map directly onto the Greek lexical field of 'glory' (doxa), 'incorruption' (aphtharsia), 'immortality' (athanasia), 'spiritual body' (soma pneumatikon), 'we shall be changed' (allagesometha), 'conformed' (symmorphos), so the verdict is derived from the words and not from the framing. Correction logged versus the prior file. The key term for First John 3:2 was retagged from G3666 (the verb 'to make like' (homoioo) of the parable

formulas) to G3664 (the adjective 'like or resembling' (homoios)), which is the form actually present in the verse and confirmed to contain First John 3:2 in the concordance. The 'to glorify' (doxazo) canon count was corrected from 61 to the queried 62. 'Conformed' (symmorphos) G4832 and 'to change in fashion' (metaschematizo) G3345 were added as anchors after direct queries showed 'conformed' (symmorphos) occurs only twice, Romans 8:29 and Philippians 3:21, both conformity to Christ. No verdict change.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.15.42-57
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.8.18-30
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Phil.3.21
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1John.3.2
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1392
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4832
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3345
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3664
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0861
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0110
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5591
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5517
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	1Cor.15.42-57
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Rom.8.30
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1Cor.15.54->Isa.25.8
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1Cor.15.55->Hos.13.14
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1John.3.2->Job.19.26
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1John.3.2->Rom.8.29
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Phil.3.21->Col.3.4
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1Cor.15.49->2Cor.3.18

License audit

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Source	License	Redistribute
MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
TSK	public_domain	yes
OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes

Flags

